

MADE FOR Her

Shantila Lee talks to Narciso Rodriguez about everything For Her L'Eau, the couturier's latest fragrance du jour steeped in avant-garde femininity and fresh elegance

TEXT SHANTILA LEE



Michelle Obama in Narciso Rodriguez



Previous For Her fragrances and perfume ingredients



You designed that iconic black and red dress for Michelle Obama – do you see her wearing For Her L'Eau with one of your dresses? I would be deeply honoured. It has been such a privilege to continue to dress the First Lady; she's a woman of such strength, courage, intelligence and beauty. Can we look forward to a Narciso Rodriguez makeup line in the future? We're envisioning luscious pale pink nail polish! There has been great change and growth in the company during the last five years; the brand and fragrance continue to flourish tremendously. Creating a cosmetic line would certainly be challenging and fulfilling. **HC**

Who or what was your muse behind L'Eau For Her? You remember a woman not because her fragrance is overpowering, but because it's so seductive. We approached creating L'Eau in a very romantic way. I was expressing my dreams and pouring them into a bottle. There is a sense of freedom, fantasy and romance that will appeal equally to women of all ages.

How does your modern, femme, alluring aesthetic translate to For Her L'Eau? The muted colour lends

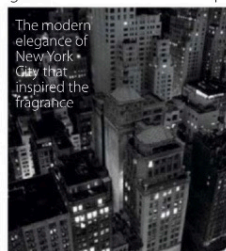
an intriguing sense of the unknown. It was inspired by the delicacy of the scent, a feeling of weightless purity and veils of soft sensuality. I wanted the L'Eau bottle to echo the tender floral aspects of the fragrance along with the spirit of spontaneity.

Why did you decide to make For Her L'Eau crisper and brighter than the previous For Her perfumes?

The collection has been evolving with a sense of freedom that's easy, fresh and sexy, and I wanted to create a fragrance that captured this freedom along with For Her's addictive quality.

"THE IDEA IS TO CONVEY TIMELESS BEAUTY, A SENSUALITY WITHOUT OVERT SEXUALITY THAT IS SIMULTANEOUSLY REFINED, ELEGANT AND AT THE SAME TIME, ACCESSIBLE."

The ad visual reflecting a modern, simple aesthetic



The modern elegance of New York City that inspired the fragrance

What motivated you to create a fragrance line? I was always very aware of fragrance, how glamorous and luxurious it was; how very special it could be and how very special it makes you feel. It was always my dream to create a fragrance that was both addictive and iconic. I wanted that dream of mine to be translated into a fragrance that would become every woman's fragrance.

What is the overarching inspiration of the For Her line? It could only be about musk, its mercurial nature, it's seductive and addictive qualities—and it's extreme femininity and singularity.

How deeply involved are you in picking perfume notes and designing the fragrance? Even when I'm involved in collaborations, like creating the fragrances, I'm always personally involved with every detail from beginning to end. Each fragrance is born out of passion and creativity—and working with really talented people to make something unique. Design that's truly personal becomes

your life because it's a constant process, whether it be making clothing, accessories or fragrance.

Is the Narciso woman wearing your perfume the same person wearing your collection? My idea of fashion is to make life easier and more pleasant by creating beautiful things that make people feel great and look great—and the same goes for the fragrance collection. The idea is to convey timeless beauty, a sensuality without overt sexuality that is simultaneously refined, elegant and at the same time, accessible.

What makes the new For Her L'Eau different from the other For Her perfumes? As always, music remains the heart of the fragrance. The power of music is magical and L'Eau captures the magic and fantasy with a spontaneity that's very seductive and unique. It embraces a modern facet of femininity that's carefree and immediate without losing the timeless—and addictive—nature of all the For Her fragrances.

PHOTOS COURTESY OF NARCISO RODRIGUEZ, CORBIS & IMAGINE

Peony notes resonate through the new fragrance